

D546

# Healthcare Policy and Governance

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | _____  |                               |

# Items

1.

A billing specialist at a 200-bed hospital that recently won a patient-safety award must submit a claim for a patient's knee surgery. She can access the full chart, including psychotherapy notes. Under HIPAA, what should she use?

- A. Only the minimum information needed for the claim.
- B. Nothing; HIPAA bars sharing with insurers.
- C. The full chart, since payment is a permitted use.
- D. Nothing until the patient signs an authorization.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which disclosure requires the patient's written authorization under HIPAA?

- A. Sharing records with a treating specialist.
- B. Billing the patient's insurer.
- C. An internal quality review.
- D. Sending records to the patient's employer for a promotion decision.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3.

A man with chest pain arrives at the emergency department of a hospital that takes Medicare and was recently ranked in the top 100. He has no insurance. What does EMTALA require?

- A. Transfer him to a public hospital because he is uninsured.
- B. Verify insurance before the screening exam.
- C. Provide all future care free of charge.
- D. A medical screening exam and stabilization, or an appropriate transfer, regardless of ability to pay.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

4.

A cardiologist who serves on her hospital's ethics committee owns 20% of an imaging center and refers her Medicare patients there for MRIs. She says she never meant to profit improperly. Which law is most directly implicated?

- A. HIPAA
- B. No law, since she had no bad intent.
- C. The Stark Law, which applies regardless of intent unless an exception fits.
- D. Only the Anti-Kickback Statute, because it requires intent.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A medical supply company gives a nursing home administrator, who is not a physician, gift cards for steering residents' Medicare supply orders to it. Which law applies most directly?

- A. EMTALA
- B. The Anti-Kickback Statute
- C. The Stark Law
- D. Neither, since gift cards are not cash.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

6.

A hospital board member who owns a construction firm, and chairs the local chamber of commerce, votes to award the hospital's \$30 million expansion contract to his own firm without disclosing it. Which fiduciary duty is breached?

- A. Duty of care
- B. No breach if his firm's bid was lowest.
- C. Duty of loyalty
- D. Duty of obedience

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

7.

A 150-bed hospital with a new cafeteria is accredited by The Joint Commission. How does this relate to Medicare participation?

- A. Federal law requires every hospital to be accredited.
- B. It gives deemed status: the hospital is deemed to meet Medicare Conditions of Participation, subject to validation surveys.
- C. It is the hospital's state license.
- D. It matters only to private insurers.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

8.

A surgeon at a teaching hospital known for robotic surgery is about to operate. The patient, who is fully capable of deciding, has signed the consent form but says she does not understand the risks. What should happen?

- A. Have a family member consent instead.
- B. Proceed, since the form is signed.
- C. Pause so the surgeon can explain risks, benefits, and alternatives until she understands, then confirm consent.
- D. Cancel the surgery permanently.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

9.

After a state legislature passes a nurse staffing law, sponsored by a senator who was once a nurse, the health department writes rules and begins inspecting hospitals. Which stage of the policy process is this?

- A. Agenda setting
- B. Formulation
- C. Evaluation
- D. Implementation

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**10.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Researchers compare nurse-to-patient ratios and patient outcomes three years after a staffing law took effect. Which stage is this?

- A.** Implementation
- B.** Evaluation
- C.** Adoption
- D.** Agenda setting

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**11.**

A patient at a hospital with a new parking garage falls after a nurse fails to raise the bed rails despite a documented fall-risk order; the patient breaks a hip. The nurse had worked a double shift. Which negligence element links the missed rails to the broken hip?

- A.** Causation
- B.** Damages
- C.** None; the double shift excuses the error.
- D.** Breach

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**12.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse gave the wrong dose, but the patient suffered no harm. Which negligence element is missing?

- A.** Damages
- B.** Duty
- C.** Causation
- D.** Breach

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer A Concept 1

A billing specialist at a 200-bed hospital ~~that recently won a patient safety award~~ must submit a claim for a patient's knee surgery. She can access the full chart, including psychotherapy notes. Under HIPAA, what should she use?

**Target word:** what to disclose **Decides:** Payment use is limited to the minimum necessary.

|   |                   |                                                        |
|---|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | Payment disclosures must be limited to what is needed. |
| B | Absolute language | Disclosures for payment are permitted.                 |
| C | Dropped element   | Drops the minimum-necessary limit.                     |
| D | Adjacent category | Payment uses do not need authorization.                |

## 2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

Which disclosure requires the patient's written authorization under HIPAA?

**Target word:** reverse: which use needs authorization **Decides:** The purpose falls outside treatment, payment, and operations.

|   |                    |                                                          |
|---|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set      | A treatment use.                                         |
| B | Adjacent category  | A payment use.                                           |
| C | Inverted operation | Health care operations; permitted without authorization. |
| D | <b>Correct</b>     | Not treatment, payment, or operations.                   |

## 3. Answer D Concept 2

A man with chest pain arrives at the emergency department of a hospital that takes Medicare ~~and was recently ranked in the top 100~~. He has no insurance. What does EMTALA require?

**Target word:** EMTALA duty **Decides:** Medicare hospital plus a possible emergency condition.

|   |                    |                                                               |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set      | Transfer for financial reasons is prohibited patient dumping. |
| B | Inverted operation | Payment questions must not delay screening.                   |
| C | Absolute language  | EMTALA requires screening and stabilization, not free care.   |
| D | <b>Correct</b>     | The core EMTALA duties.                                       |

## 4. Answer C Concept 3

A cardiologist ~~who serves on her hospital's ethics committee~~ owns 20% of an imaging center and refers her Medicare patients there for MRIs. She says she never meant to profit improperly. Which law is most directly implicated?

**Target word:** law **Decides:** A physician refers to an entity she owns part of.

|   |                   |                                                                             |
|---|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Adjacent category | Privacy law, not referral law.                                              |
| B | Dropped element   | Stark does not require intent.                                              |
| C | <b>Correct</b>    | Physician self-referral for designated health services is strict liability. |
| D | Confusion set     | The self-referral ownership tie points to Stark first.                      |

### 5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A medical supply company gives a nursing home administrator, who is not a physician, gift cards for steering residents' Medicare supply orders to it. Which law applies most directly?

**Target word:** reverse: facts to law **Decides:** Anything of value for federal-program referrals, by a non-physician.

|          |                   |                                                        |
|----------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category | Covers emergency screening.                            |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | It covers anyone paying for federal-program referrals. |
| C        | Confusion set     | Stark needs a physician referral.                      |
| D        | Dropped element   | "Anything of value" includes gift cards.               |

### 6. Answer C Concept 4

A hospital board member who owns a construction firm, ~~and chairs the local chamber of commerce,~~ votes to award the hospital's \$30 million expansion contract to his own firm without disclosing it. Which fiduciary duty is breached?

**Target word:** duty **Decides:** An undisclosed personal financial interest.

|          |                   |                                                         |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set     | About informed diligence, not self-interest.            |
| B        | Dropped element   | Disclosure and recusal are still required.              |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | A conflict of interest must be disclosed, with recusal. |
| D        | Adjacent category | About mission and law.                                  |

### 7. Answer B Concept 5

A 150-bed hospital ~~with a new cafeteria~~ is accredited by The Joint Commission. How does this relate to Medicare participation?

**Target word:** effect of accreditation **Decides:** Joint Commission is a CMS-approved accrediting body.

|          |                   |                                                                |
|----------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Absolute language | Accreditation is voluntary; state surveys are the alternative. |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Accreditation substitutes for a state survey for Medicare.     |
| C        | Confusion set     | Licensure is separate and issued by the state.                 |
| D        | Adjacent category | Its key effect is on Medicare participation.                   |

### 8. Answer C Concept 6

A surgeon at a teaching hospital ~~known for robotic surgery~~ is about to operate. The patient, who is fully capable of deciding, has signed the consent form but says she does not understand the risks. What should happen?

**Target word:** consent action **Decides:** She does not understand the risks.

|          |                   |                                                           |
|----------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category | Surrogates are used only when the patient lacks capacity. |
| B        | Dropped element   | Drops the understanding requirement.                      |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Understanding, not the signature, makes consent valid.    |
| D        | Absolute language | Explaining can resolve the problem.                       |

### 9. Answer D Concept 7

After a state legislature passes a nurse staffing law, ~~sponsored by a senator who was once a nurse~~, the health department writes rules and begins inspecting hospitals. Which stage of the policy process is this?

**Target word:** stage **Decides:** Rules and enforcement after passage.

|   |                    |                                      |
|---|--------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | The first stage.                     |
| B | Confusion set      | Drafting the policy before adoption. |
| C | Adjacent category  | Judging results comes later.         |
| D | <b>Correct</b>     | Agencies carry out an adopted law.   |

### 10. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

Researchers compare nurse-to-patient ratios and patient outcomes three years after a staffing law took effect. Which stage is this?

**Target word:** reverse: activity to stage **Decides:** Judging results.

|   |                    |                                          |
|---|--------------------|------------------------------------------|
| A | Adjacent category  | Carrying out the law, which came before. |
| B | <b>Correct</b>     | Assesses whether the policy worked.      |
| C | Inverted operation | Passing the law.                         |
| D | Confusion set      | Raising the issue at the start.          |

### 11. Answer A Concept 8

A patient at a hospital ~~with a new parking garage~~ falls after a nurse fails to raise the bed rails despite a documented fall-risk order; the patient breaks a hip. ~~The nurse had worked a double shift.~~ Which negligence element links the missed rails to the broken hip?

**Target word:** element **Decides:** The link between the breach and the injury.

|   |                   |                                                       |
|---|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | Shows that the breach produced the injury.            |
| B | Confusion set     | The broken hip is the damages.                        |
| C | Camouflage        | Fatigue does not remove liability.                    |
| D | Adjacent category | The missed rails are the breach itself, not the link. |

### 12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A nurse gave the wrong dose, but the patient suffered no harm. Which negligence element is missing?

**Target word:** missing element **Decides:** No harm.

|   |                    |                                            |
|---|--------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | Without harm there is no negligence claim. |
| B | Confusion set      | The nurse clearly owed a duty.             |
| C | Adjacent category  | Nothing harmful exists to be caused.       |
| D | Inverted operation | The wrong dose is a breach.                |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | Right                                                 | Wrong                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| Trap               | What it does                                                 | In this drill | Your misses |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 5             |             |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 0             |             |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 11            |             |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 5             |             |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 4             |             |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 10            |             |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 1             |             |

## Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                           | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                  | Trap                                                                       | Tell                                                          |
|---|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>HIPAA minimum necessary and permitted uses</b> | Treatment, payment, and operations uses need no authorization, but uses other than treatment are limited to the minimum necessary; other uses need written authorization.             | Thinking payment purposes allow sharing the full chart.                    | A staff member with broad access doing a narrow task.         |
| 2 | <b>EMTALA</b>                                     | Hospitals that take Medicare must screen and stabilize anyone with an emergency condition, whatever their ability to pay.                                                             | Checking insurance before screening.                                       | An uninsured patient arrives at the ED.                       |
| 3 | <b>Stark Law vs. Anti-Kickback Statute</b>        | Stark bars physician referrals to entities they have financial ties with (strict liability); the AKS bars knowingly paying anything of value for federal-program referrals by anyone. | Thinking lack of intent avoids Stark, or that Stark covers non-physicians. | Who refers, what the tie is, and whether intent is mentioned. |
| 4 | <b>Board fiduciary duties</b>                     | Care = informed diligence; loyalty = put the organization first and disclose conflicts; obedience = follow the mission and law.                                                       | Calling a conflict of interest a duty-of-care issue.                       | A board member benefits personally from a vote.               |
| 5 | <b>Accreditation and deemed status</b>            | Accreditation by a CMS-approved body such as The Joint Commission deems a hospital to meet Medicare Conditions of Participation.                                                      | Thinking accreditation is required by law or is a state license.           | Accreditation mentioned with Medicare participation.          |
| 6 | <b>Informed consent</b>                           | Valid consent requires that a capable patient understands risks, benefits, and alternatives; a signature alone is not enough.                                                         | Treating the signed form as the consent.                                   | A patient signs but says she does not understand.             |
| 7 | <b>Policy process stages</b>                      | Agenda setting, formulation, adoption, implementation, and evaluation.                                                                                                                | Calling rule writing after passage “formulation.”                          | What happens after a law passes.                              |
| 8 | <b>Elements of negligence</b>                     | Duty, breach, causation, and damages must all be shown.                                                                                                                               | Confusing breach with causation.                                           | An error and an injury: what links them?                      |

**Course scope (public description):** Healthcare Policy and Governance provides a comprehensive exploration of healthcare administration, focusing on healthcare policies, regulations, and governance and their impact on operations, administration, and community health services. Students develop skills to evaluate implications, assess regulatory frameworks, and comprehend legal and ethical considerations in healthcare administration and community health services. The course equips students with the knowledge to navigate the healthcare system, make informed decisions, and contribute to high-quality care and patient outcomes.